- *5xx*—Server error. A problem on the server caused the request to fail.

These status codes typically drive the behavior of a user's browser. The browser will handle a 301 response automatically, for example, by redirecting to the provided new link and making a second request, all without the user's interaction.

Error codes are in the 4xx and 5xx classes. Common codes include a 404 response when a file couldn't be found, a 400 error when a client sends invalid data (such as an invalid email address), and a 500 error when an error occurs on the server. HTTP responses for error codes may include a response body, which is content to display when the client receives the response.

This basic ASP.NET Core application makes it easy to see the behavior of the ASP.NET Core middleware pipeline and the static-file middleware in particular, but it's unlikely that your applications will be this simple. It's more likely that static files will form one part of your middleware pipeline. In the next section you'll see how to combine multiple middleware components as we look at a simple minimal API application.

4.2.3 Simple pipeline scenario 3: A minimal API application

By this point, you should have a decent grasp of the middleware pipeline, insofar as you understand that it defines your application's behavior. In this section you'll see how to combine several standard middleware components to form a pipeline. As before, you do this in Program.cs by adding middleware to the `WebApplication` object.

You'll begin by creating a basic middleware pipeline that you'd find in a typical ASP.NET Core minimal APIs template and then extend it by adding middleware. Figure 4.10 shows the output you see when you navigate to the home page of the application—identical to the sample application in chapter 3.